



A STRONGER
NORTHFIELD
TOGETHER

South Gateway & Riverside Neighborhood Revitalization Plan

A MORE CONNECTED, VIBRANT AND EQUITABLE NORTHFIELD

BEFORE

Underutilized Land | Disconnected Neighborhoods
Limited Access to the River



AFTER

Mixed-Income Housing | Local Businesses | Green Space
Complete Streets | River Access | A More Connected Northfield



MOCK MUNICIPAL PLANNING PROPOSAL

City of Northfield, NY | RFP No. 2026-PLN-07

September 2026

*From Opportunity
to Community*

Cover Letter

October 30, 2026
Procurement Office
City of Northfield, New York

Re: RFP No. 2026-PLN-07 - South Gateway & Riverside Neighborhood Revitalization Plan

Dear Evaluation Committee:

Bailey Planning + Community Development is pleased to submit this proposal to prepare the South Gateway & Riverside Neighborhood Revitalization Plan. We understand that Northfield is seeking more than a policy document: the City needs a community-supported investment framework that connects land use, housing, mobility, economic development, environmental conditions, public space, zoning, funding and implementation.

Our revised 16-month work program creates adequate time for rigorous analysis, sustained community engagement, catalyst-site testing, zoning recommendations, grant-readiness work and public review. The assignment will be led by Rachel S. Bailey, M.U.P., supported by illustrative specialist subconsultants in engagement, GIS/data, transportation and urban design.

Our proposed not-to-exceed fee is \$319,400, including reimbursable expenses, within the City's \$325,000 maximum. The scope, schedule and fee have been reconciled so that the proposal directly responds to all nine RFP tasks and provides the City with implementable, visually compelling and funding-oriented deliverables.

Sincerely,
Rachel S. Bailey, M.U.P.
Project Manager / Lead Planner
Bailey Planning + Community Development

Proposal Contents

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2	Project Understanding
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4	Community Engagement
5	Visual Planning & Catalyst Concepts
6	Schedule
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1. Executive Summary

South Gateway and Riverside present a connected set of challenges and opportunities: vacant and underutilized land, legacy industrial and commercial properties, housing affordability pressures, transportation barriers, environmental concerns, and a riverfront that can become a stronger neighborhood asset. Our approach moves from listening and evidence to concepts, testing, implementation and action.

16-MONTH PLANNING PROCESS

A clear progression from project launch through adoption and implementation.



- Community-centered: engagement continues throughout the project.
- Data-informed: analysis is translated into practical decision tools.
- Implementation-focused: recommendations identify responsibility, timing, cost and funding.

- Community-centered - engagement is continuous and traceable from input to plan response.
- Data-informed - GIS, demographic, housing, market, transportation and environmental findings are translated into decision tools.
- Design-literate - priority sites and corridors are illustrated with concept plans, sections and before/after visualizations.
- Equity-conscious - affordability, displacement risk, accessibility and environmental justice are tested throughout.
- Implementation-focused - recommendations identify lead entities, partners, timing, preliminary costs, funding sources and measurable next steps.

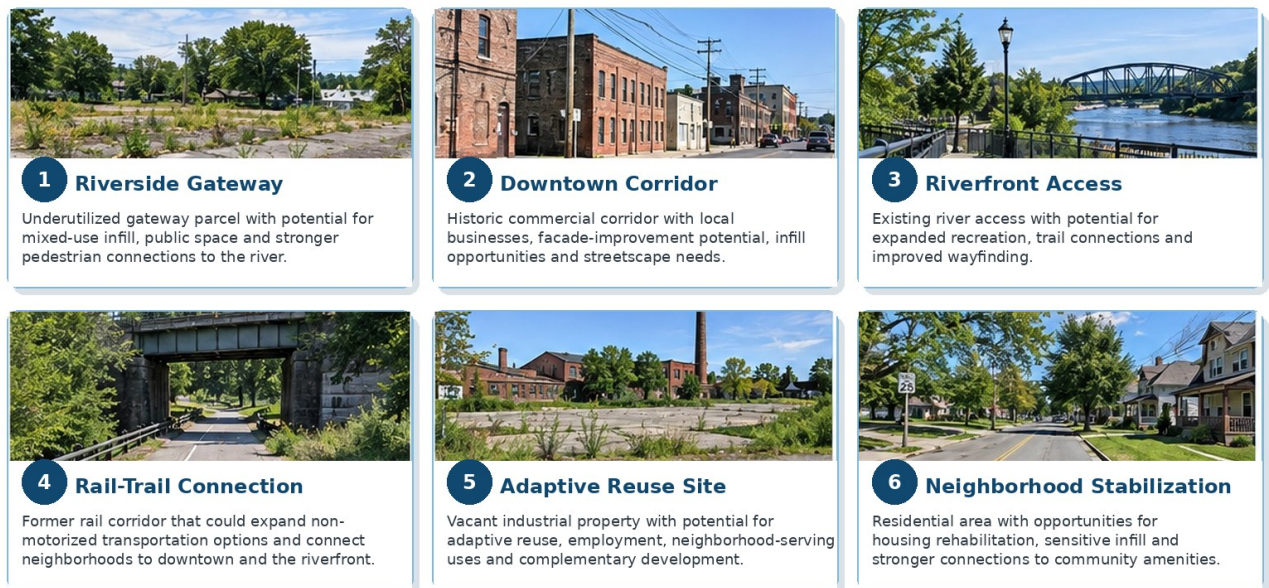
Schedule: 16 months, January 2027-April 2028. **Fee:** \$319,400 not-to-exceed.

2. Project Understanding

The South Gateway and Riverside study area is envisioned as a transition zone between established neighborhoods, commercial and former industrial land, community institutions, transportation infrastructure and the river. The central planning challenge is to ensure that reinvestment improves everyday life for existing residents while creating room for new housing, businesses, public space and safer connections.

SOUTH GATEWAY & RIVERSIDE - ILLUSTRATIVE EXISTING SITE CONDITIONS

Conceptual study areas shown with realistic site imagery for this fictional portfolio project.



Illustrative portfolio imagery - Northfield is fictional; images are concept visuals, not documented existing conditions.

Planning Questions We Will Resolve

- Where can public investment unlock the greatest neighborhood benefit?
- Which vacant, obsolete or underutilized properties are realistic candidates for infill, adaptive reuse or mixed-use redevelopment?
- How can new mixed-income housing be paired with preservation and anti-displacement tools?
- How should Complete Streets, transit, trails, pedestrian crossings and river access function as one connectivity network?
- What zoning changes are necessary to enable the desired pattern while protecting neighborhood character?
- Which projects can be made grant-ready within the planning process?

3. Technical Approach & Scope of Work

Task 1 - Project Initiation & Management

Kickoff, project charter, detailed schedule, data request, stakeholder map, decision protocols, biweekly project management meetings, monthly progress reports, risk/action log, and quality-control procedures.

Deliverables: Project Management Plan; detailed schedule; data inventory; meeting summaries; monthly progress reports.

Task 2 - Existing Conditions, GIS & Field Analysis

Parcel, land use, zoning, demographic, housing, transportation, environmental, infrastructure, public-realm and community-asset analysis; field reconnaissance and photographic inventory; opportunities/constraints synthesis.

Deliverables: Existing Conditions Report; GIS geodatabase and map series; photo inventory; Opportunities & Constraints Map; presentation.

Task 3 - Community & Stakeholder Engagement

Inclusive engagement program with at least four public meetings/open houses, four neighborhood workshops, 20-25 stakeholder interviews, two business roundtables, youth/family engagement, advisory committee meetings, online/paper survey and pop-up outreach.

Deliverables: Engagement Plan; materials; survey/interview findings; meeting summaries; engagement database; final Engagement Summary.

Task 4 - Market, Housing & Development Opportunity Analysis

Housing needs and affordability; tenure/vacancy; commercial and development trends; displacement risk; priority-site screening; concept-level redevelopment scenarios and feasibility considerations.

Deliverables: Housing & Development Opportunity Analysis; priority-site inventory; catalyst-site concepts; opportunity maps.

Task 5 - Transportation, Mobility & Connectivity

Pedestrian, bicycle, transit, vehicular, parking, ADA and safety review; river/trail access; Complete Streets opportunities; priority intersection and corridor concepts.

Deliverables: Transportation Conditions Assessment; connectivity network; Complete Streets recommendations; priority project concepts.

Task 6 - Community Vision, Urban Design & Revitalization Framework

Synthesize analysis and engagement into a place-based framework covering land use, housing, economic development, mobility, public realm, open space, resilience, neighborhood identity and catalytic investment.

Deliverables: Vision statement; revitalization framework; illustrative concept plans/sections; before-after visualizations; priority recommendations.

Task 7 - Zoning & Land Use Recommendations

Diagnostic of existing zoning and development standards; identify map/text amendments, mixed-use opportunities, adaptive reuse, parking reforms, design standards and affordability tools.

Deliverables: Zoning assessment; recommended map/text amendments; implementation sequence.

Task 8 - Implementation, Funding & Grant Readiness

Implementation matrix with priority, lead entity, partners, timeframe, preliminary cost, dependencies, metrics and funding; five-year action plan; identify and outline at least three grant-ready projects.

Deliverables: Implementation Matrix; Funding Strategy; Five-Year Action Plan; three grant-ready project sheets.

Task 9 - Draft Plan, Adoption Support & Final Deliverables

Prepare draft and final plan; executive summary; public presentation; staff/board briefings; comment matrix; final accessible files and editable source materials.

Deliverables: Draft Plan; comment matrix; Final Plan; Executive Summary; presentations; GIS; graphics; editable source files.

4. Community Engagement Approach

Our engagement strategy is designed around access, trust, multiple ways to participate and a visible feedback loop. Residents should be able to see where their input appears in the plan, where technical or legal constraints affect an idea, and what the City can do next.

COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT FRAMEWORK

Multiple ways to participate - with a visible feedback loop from input to action.

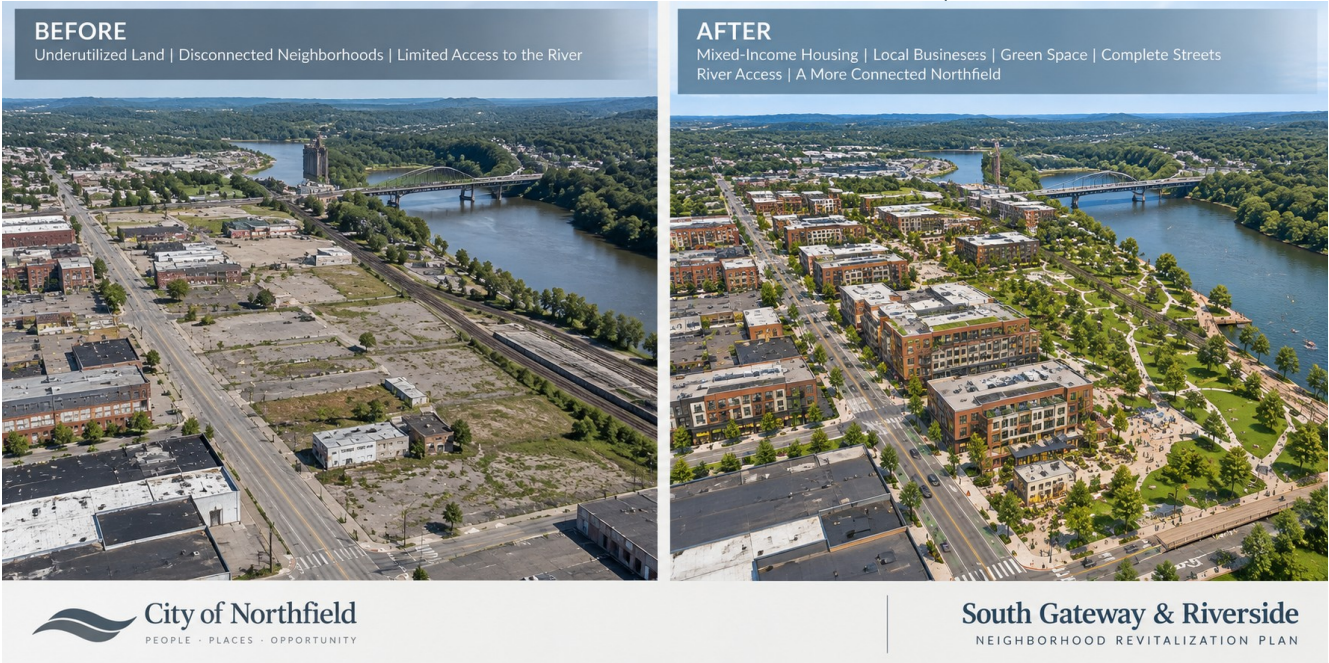


Accessibility: plain-language materials, ADA-accessible locations, evening/weekend scheduling, translated materials or interpretation as needed, large-format visuals, and non-digital participation options.

Engagement Element	Planned Level
Advisory Committee	6 milestone meetings
Public Meetings / Open Houses	4
Neighborhood Workshops	4
Stakeholder Interviews	20-25
Business Roundtables	2
Youth / Family Activities	2 partner-based events
Pop-Ups	At least 4
Survey	Online + paper; multilingual as needed

5. Visual Planning & Catalyst Concepts

Visual communication is treated as a planning tool, not decoration. The team will use maps, diagrams, photo documentation, concept plans and representative renderings to help residents and decision-makers understand tradeoffs and test alternatives.



Illustrative Before/After Concept: underutilized land and disconnected river access transformed through mixed-income housing, local business space, green space, Complete Streets and stronger river connections. This image is conceptual and does not depict an actual Northfield site.

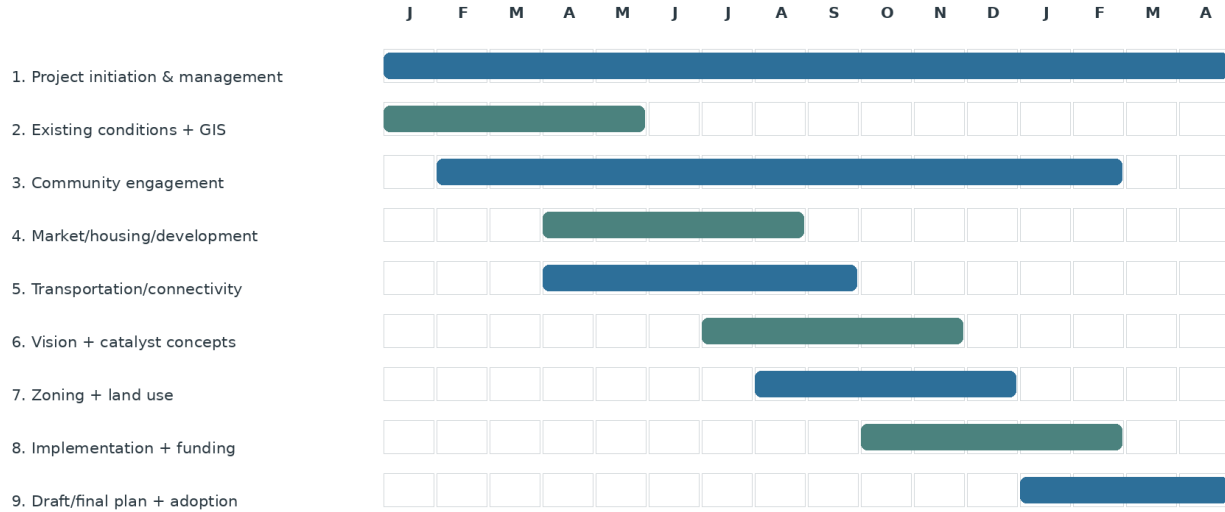
Illustrative Catalyst Project Sheets

Catalyst	Concept	Potential Implementation Tools
South Gateway Mixed-Use Infill	Mixed-income housing over neighborhood-serving commercial space; improved streetscape and transit access.	LIHTC/affordable housing programs; CDBG; HOME; private debt/equity; zoning incentives.
Riverside Greenway & Access	Continuous riverfront trail, accessible crossings, park improvements, stormwater landscapes and neighborhood connections.	Transportation grants; parks/open-space funds; climate/resilience grants; capital program.
Adaptive Reuse / Maker-Commercial Hub	Reuse of legacy building for small business, maker, community-serving and flexible employment space.	Brownfield programs; economic development grants; historic credits where eligible; local incentives.

6. Project Schedule

The revised 16-month schedule is intentionally longer than the earlier 12-month concept. The added time supports deeper engagement, stronger catalyst-site work, grant-readiness, zoning analysis and a meaningful public review/adoption period.

PROJECT SCHEDULE | JANUARY 2027 - APRIL 2028



Period	Major Activities / Milestones
Jan-Feb 2027	Kickoff, project charter, data transfer, advisory committee, stakeholder mapping
Mar-May 2027	Existing conditions, GIS, field work, interviews, survey, Public Meeting 1
Jun-Aug 2027	Housing/market/development and transportation analysis; workshops; business/youth engagement
Sep-Oct 2027	Priority sites, alternatives, catalyst concepts, Public Meeting 2
Nov-Dec 2027	Revitalization framework; urban design; zoning diagnostic; Public Meeting 3
Jan-Feb 2028	Implementation matrix, funding strategy, grant-ready project sheets
Mar 2028	Draft plan, open house/Public Meeting 4, City/board review
Apr 2028	Final plan, executive summary, adoption support, GIS/graphics/editable files

7. Project Team

Team Member	Role	Primary Responsibility
Rachel S. Bailey, M.U.P.	Project Manager / Lead Planner	Overall management; land use; housing/community development; technical writing; implementation; client coordination
Illustrative Senior Planner, AICP	Principal-in-Charge / QA-QC	Senior review; municipal planning; zoning; quality control
Illustrative Engagement Lead	Community Engagement	Engagement design; facilitation; outreach; survey/interview synthesis
Illustrative GIS / Data Analyst	GIS & Research	Spatial, demographic and parcel analysis; mapping
Illustrative Transportation Planner, P.E.	Transportation Subconsultant	Complete Streets; safety; transit; connectivity
Illustrative Urban Designer	Urban Design	Concept plans, sections, streetscape and redevelopment visualization

The team structure is illustrative for this portfolio exercise and demonstrates how a proposal coordinator would organize a multidisciplinary municipal planning response.

8. Project Manager Resume - Rachel S. Bailey, M.U.P.

Urban planning, affordable housing, community development, program management, proposal development, technical writing, data analysis and public presentation experience. Graduate planning education is paired with hands-on affordable housing development, construction/project management, grant compliance and community-based housing work.

Education & Training

- M.U.P., University at Buffalo - Neighborhood & Community Development, 2021
- B.A., Economics; A.A.S., Architecture
- Relevant coursework: Housing & Community Development; Land Use; Environmental Planning & Policy; Environmental Economics; Urban Design; Transportation; Economic Development; Planning Methods; GIS; Nonprofit Management; Land Use Law
- Additional training: construction finance, financial modeling, affordable housing compliance and LIHTC/multifamily housing finance

Selected Experience

- Family Services Manager - community-based program administration, staff supervision, service coordination, procedures and data tracking.
- Homeless Outreach / Emergency Family Shelter Program Manager - program analytics, HMIS, coordinated entry, public-agency coordination, compliance, billing, staff supervision and crisis response.
- Housing Development Manager / Project Manager - affordable single-family development exceeding \$2 million, HUD-funded activities, construction budgets, contractor coordination, M/WBE compliance, closings and delivery.
- Marketing / proposal / procurement experience - RFP development, proposal coordination, marketing collateral, technical writing, presentations, purchasing and cross-functional coordination.

9. Relevant Experience

Project	Relevance	Selected Scope / Outcome
Homelessness in Rochester and Beyond	Housing & community development research	Research and 90-minute professional planning presentation examining causes, barriers, solutions and planning implications.
Northeast Greenway / Rail-to-Trail Studio	Transportation, land use & environmental planning	Corridor planning, rail-to-trail activation, connectivity, community context, environmental considerations and implementation concepts.
Buffalo Innovation District Feasibility	Economic development & urban planning	Planning report evaluating innovation-district conditions, market/land-use factors, institutional assets and place-based strategies.
Rochester 2034 Comprehensive Plan Review	Comprehensive planning / policy analysis	Plan review, policy communication, implementation themes and community development considerations.
Affordable Housing Development Applications	Housing finance & development	Mock LIHTC feasibility, budgets, sources/uses, eligible basis, equity, debt sizing and QAP scoring.

10. Cost Proposal

Task	Fee
1. Project Initiation & Management	\$28,500
2. Existing Conditions, GIS & Field Analysis	\$47,500
3. Community & Stakeholder Engagement	\$46,500
4. Market, Housing & Development Analysis	\$39,000
5. Transportation, Mobility & Connectivity	\$33,500
6. Vision, Urban Design & Revitalization Framework	\$40,500
7. Zoning & Land Use Recommendations	\$24,500

8. Implementation, Funding & Grant Readiness	\$31,500
9. Draft Plan, Adoption Support & Final Deliverables	\$22,500
Direct / reimbursable expenses	\$5,400
TOTAL NOT-TO-EXCEED	\$319,400

The revised fee reflects the expanded 16-month schedule, four public meetings, additional workshops/interviews, catalyst-site visualization, zoning analysis, implementation/funding work and three grant-ready project sheets. No work beyond the not-to-exceed amount would proceed without written City authorization.

11. Compliance Matrix

RFP Requirement	Proposal Location	Status
Cover letter	Front matter	Complete
Executive summary	Section 1	Complete
Project understanding	Section 2	Complete
All nine technical tasks	Section 3	Complete
Community engagement	Section 4	Complete
Visual/catalyst concepts	Section 5	Value-added
16-month schedule	Section 6	Complete
Team / organization	Section 7	Complete
Resume	Section 8	Complete
Relevant experience	Section 9	Complete
Cost proposal	Section 10	Complete - \$319,400
MWBE / subconsultant strategy	Appendix narrative	Mock strategy only
Forms A-I	Separate City forms	Not fabricated in portfolio sample

12. Appendix - Illustrative Deliverables

The following items illustrate the types of graphics and decision tools that would accompany the final plan.

SOUTH GATEWAY & RIVERSIDE - ILLUSTRATIVE EXISTING SITE CONDITIONS

Conceptual study areas shown with realistic site imagery for this fictional portfolio project.



1 Riverside Gateway
Underutilized gateway parcel with potential for mixed-use infill, public space and stronger pedestrian connections to the river.



2 Downtown Corridor
Historic commercial corridor with local businesses, facade-improvement potential, infill opportunities and streetscape needs.



3 Riverfront Access
Existing river access with potential for expanded recreation, trail connections and improved wayfinding.



4 Rail-Trail Connection
Former rail corridor that could expand non-motorized transportation options and connect neighborhoods to downtown and the riverfront.



5 Adaptive Reuse Site
Vacant industrial property with potential for adaptive reuse, employment, neighborhood-serving uses and complementary development.

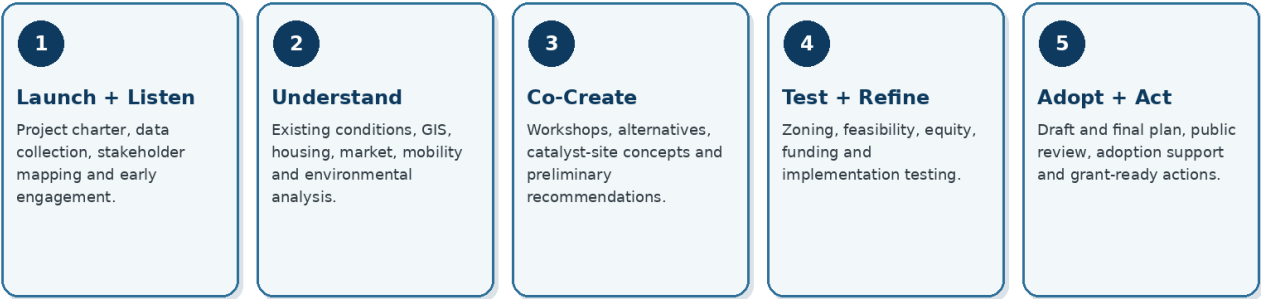


6 Neighborhood Stabilization
Residential area with opportunities for housing rehabilitation, sensitive infill and stronger connections to community amenities.

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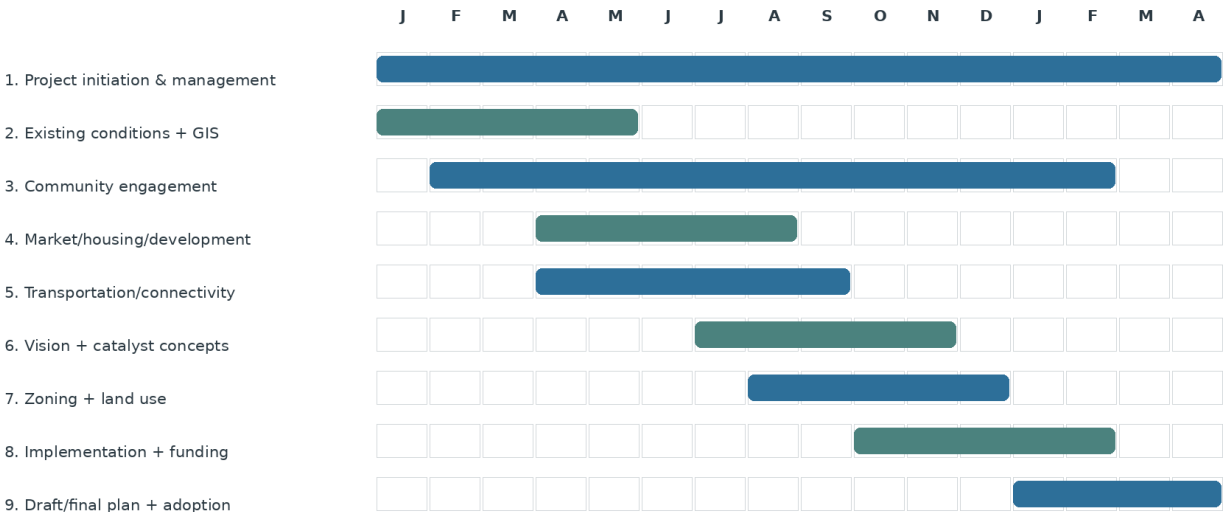
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PROJECT SCHEDULE | JANUARY 2027 - APRIL 2028



Illustrative Implementation Matrix

Action	Lead / Partners	Timing	Order-of-Magnitude Cost	Potential Funding
South Gateway mixed-use catalyst site predevelopment	City + development partner	0-2 years	\$250K-\$750K predevelopment	CDBG/HOME; housing programs; private sources
Riverside trail and access design	City + transportation/parks partners	0-2 years	\$500K-\$1.5M design/early phases	Transportation; parks; climate/resilience
Complete Streets priority corridor	City / DOT / transit	1-4 years	\$3M-\$8M	Federal/state transportation; capital program
Adaptive reuse feasibility and brownfield work	City + property/development partners	0-3 years	\$150K-\$500K	Brownfield; economic development; historic tools
Zoning text/map amendments	City	0-2 years	Staff + consultant	Local budget / planning grants

END OF MOCK PROPOSAL